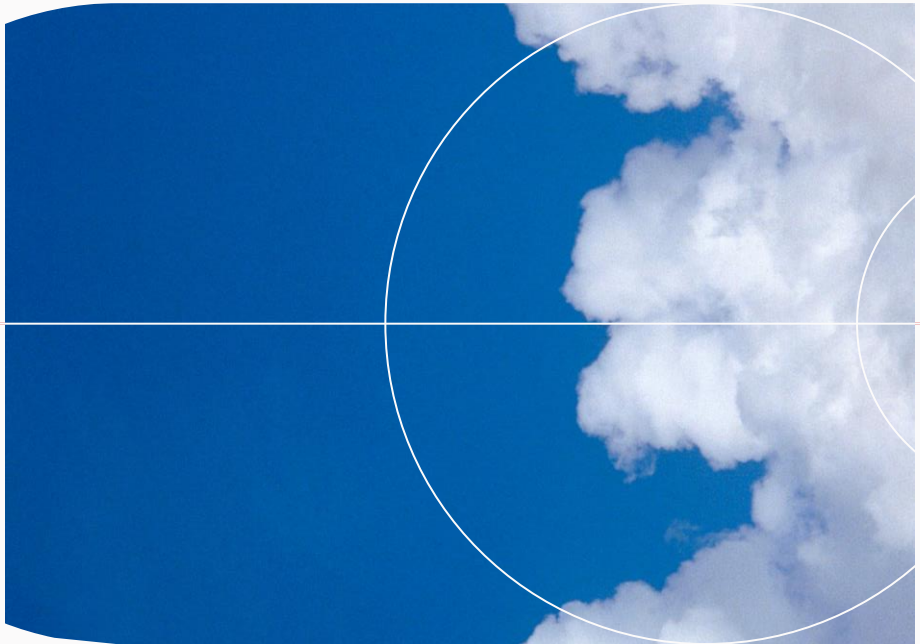
Negative self-talk:
Why's it so bad, and what can we do about it?



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Why is negative self-talk so bad?

Negative self-talk affects our self-esteem, which in turn affects our mental health.

It can even affect our physical abilities.

UK National Institute of Health. (2023, April).

Raising low self-esteem. Retrieved from NHS: https://www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/tips-and-support/raise-low-self-esteem/

Hardy, J., Roberts, R., & Hardy, L. (2009).

Awareness and Motivation to Change Negative Self-Talk. Sports Psychologist, 435-450.

What can we do about it?

STEP 1: Recognize when negative self-talk happens.

STEP 2: Evaluate: is this true? Is this fair?

STEP 3: “Reframe” the thought.

Rivernorth Counseling. (2026, April 8).

How to Stop Negative Self-Talk and Build Self-Respect. Retrieved from Rivernorth Counseling: https://www.rivernorthcounseling.com/counseling/how-to-stop-negative-self-talk-and-build-self-respect/

Why should we do anything about negative self-talk?

Improving negative self-talk has been linked to:

- better mental health outcomes
- improved focus and motivation
- an increase in emotional regulation skills

Racy, F., & Morin, A. (2024).

Relationships between Self-Talk, Inner Speech, Mind Wandering, Mindfulness, Self-Concept Clarity, and Self-Regulation in University Students. *Behavioral Sciences, Mount Royal University*, 1, 8-9.

“Be nice to yourself — it’s hard to be happy when someone is mean to you all the time.”

- CHRISTINE ARYLO

